I laughed. She laughed. What other reaction could there be? In this mixed-up world, this pain-filled life, we'd done it. We'd managed to find each other.

Then we were crying *and* laughing, and petting Guy, who looked frozen solid.

We started for the house.

Oh, wait. Don't you want to see the ring, my love?

She hadn't even thought about it.

We hurried inside, finished our celebration in the warmth of the kitchen.

It was November 4.

We managed to keep it secret for about two weeks.

36.

Ordinarily, I'd have gone to Meg's father first, asked for his blessing. But Thomas Markle was a complicated man.

He and Meg's mother split when she was two, and thereafter she divided her time between them. Monday to Friday with Mum, weekends with Dad. Then, for part of high school, she'd moved in with her father full-time. They were that close.

After college she'd traveled the world, but always stayed in constant contact with Daddy. She still, even in her thirties, called him Daddy. She loved him, worried about him—his health, his habits—and often relied upon him. Throughout her run on *Suits* she'd consulted him every week about the lighting. (He'd been a lighting director in Hollywood, won two Emmys.) In recent years, however, he hadn't been working regularly, and he'd sort of disappeared. He'd rented a small house in a Mexican border town and wasn't doing well overall.

In every way, Meg felt, her father would never be able to withstand the psychological pressures that come with being stalked by the press, and that was now happening to him. It had long been open season on everyone in Meg's circle, every current friend and ex-boyfriend, every cousin, including those she'd never known, every former employer or former co-worker, but after I proposed there was a frenzy around…the Father. He was considered the prize